

- Antivirus and anti-malware
 - Anti-phishing
 - Network attack protection
 - Password Managers:
- **LastPass (Multiple platforms):** Securely stores and manages passwords across devices, offering strong password generation and autofill functionalities. Integrates with major browsers and applications.
 - **1Password (Multiple platforms):** Renowned for its robust security features and ease of use. Offers:
 - Secure password sharing
 - Travel mode (stores sensitive data locally)
 - Dark web monitoring (additional subscription)
 - **Dashlane (Multiple platforms):** Another excellent option with advanced features like:
 - Secure password sharing with family/friends
 - Data breach monitoring
 - Secure document storage

VPN Services:

- **ExpressVPN (Multiple platforms):** Offers top-tier encrypted internet access, IP masking, and a vast global server network to bypass geo-restrictions.
- **NordVPN (Multiple platforms):** Known for its strong focus on privacy and security. Features include:
 - Double VPN (extra layer of encryption)
 - Strict no-logs policy
 - Threat protection

Additional Security Considerations:

- **Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):** Enable MFA wherever possible for an extra layer of login security.
- **Regular Software Updates:** Ensure your operating system, applications, and firmware are updated promptly to address security vulnerabilities.
- **Phishing Awareness:** Be cautious of suspicious emails, text messages, or calls urging you to click on links or disclose personal information.

Educational Resources

- **Cybrary (Online):** A comprehensive platform offering free cybersecurity courses for beginners to advanced users, covering topics like ethical hacking and information security.
- **SANS Institute (Online):** Provides in-depth cybersecurity training courses and certifications recognised globally.
- **National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) (Online):** Offers a wealth of resources and publications on cybersecurity best practices and frameworks.
- **Open Web Application Security Project (OWASP) (Online):** A valuable resource for developers and security professionals, providing guidance on securing web applications. Remember, this isn't all there is to being digitally safe online.

Conducting a Personal Security Audit

Here's how to conduct a comprehensive personal security audit to identify potential risks and fortify your digital defenses.

Inventory Your Digital Assets:

- **Make a list:** Social media accounts (Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, etc.), online banking platforms, email providers, cloud storage services (Dropbox, Google Drive, etc.), online shopping accounts, and any other platforms where you have a digital presence.

Scrutinize Your Security Measures:

- **Password Strength:** Utilize strong, unique passwords for each platform. Consider using a password manager like LastPass, 1Password, or Dashlane to generate and securely store complex passwords.
- **Two-Factor Authentication (MFA):** Enable MFA wherever possible. This adds an extra layer of security by requiring a secondary verification code during login, typically sent to your phone.
- **Software Protections:**
 - **Antivirus and Anti-malware:** Ensure you have reputable antivirus and anti-malware software installed and running on your devices. Popular options include Norton 360, Bitdefender, and Kaspersky.
 - **Firewall:** Consider using a built-in firewall (Windows Defender Firewall) or a third-party option like Eset Smart Security Premium.

Deep Dive into Data Sharing and Storage:

- **Review Privacy Settings:** Limit the information publicly visible and restrict who can contact you.
- **Data Breach Monitoring:** Services like Have I Been Pwned? (<https://haveibeenpwned.com/>) allow you to check if your email address has been compromised in any known data breaches.
- **Secure Storage:** Utilize encrypted cloud storage services like Google Drive or Dropbox with strong passwords enabled for sensitive data.

Additional Resources:

- **Online Security Checkups:** Several websites offer free security assessments. A popular option is Privacy Checkup by Google (<https://support.google.com/accounts/answer/162744?hl=en>), which helps you review your Google account privacy settings.
- **Educational Resources:**
 - **National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Cybersecurity Framework** (<https://www.nist.gov/cyber-framework>) provides a guide for managing cybersecurity risk.
 - **Open Web Application Security Project (OWASP)** (<https://owasp.org/>) offers resources on securing web applications and preventing common attacks. **d**